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DATA SNAPSHOT

The State of Customer Experience Management, 2025

Practitioner Research Report

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Principal, Value Realization, XM Institute

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2025

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Executive Summary

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KEY FINDINGS IN THIS REPORT

As part of XM Institute's 2025 Customer Experience practitioner study, we asked practitioners from organizations with 1,000 or more employees about the composition and responsibilities of their CX programs, obstacles to their success, how well they connect their work to business outcomes, and their usage of AI-powered tools. From their responses, we learned that:

+ **Nearly two-thirds of organizations remain in the first two stages of CX Competency Maturity.** Sixty-five percent of CX practitioners rate their organization's CX competency maturity as either Stage 1: Investigate (29%) or Stage 2: Initiate (36%). Twenty-one percent indicate that their organization is in the third stage of maturity: Mobilize, while 3% have have achieved the fifth stage: Embed. Use the Customer Experience (CX) Competency Maturity Assessment to evaluate your organization's CX skills and competencies.
+ **CX leaders benefit from increasing investment and stronger executive support.** Compared to CX laggards (organizations with maturity assessment scores below the median), CX leaders are more likely to report that their CEO is a strong active champion for CX. They are also 10+ percentage points more likely to say their organization will increase spending on CX training, full-time CX employees, and CX technology compared to CX laggards.
+ **Other organizational priorities is the top obstacle to CX success.** CX practitioners cite *other competing organizational priorities* most frequently as a barrier to CX success (64%). *Poor integration across systems* (49%) and *inconsistent executive buy-in* (41%) are the next most common obstacles.
+ **CX practitioners struggle to identify monetary benefits of their CX programs.** Just 17% of CX practitioners can specify a monetary benefit their CX program has contributed that their budget holders recognize. Over half (57%) report difficulties justifying or quantifying the impact of their actions, most commonly due to lack of well-defined metrics (52%) and lack of resources for analysis (47%).
+ **CX programs are using AI-powered tools.** Eighty-eight percent of of practitioners say their organization is implementing AI to some degree. Among these organizations, the most popular AI-related activities include *establishing data security & privacy policies* (64%) and *defining clear standards & principles for internal AI usage* (61%). *Chatbots and virtual assistants* are the most popular tools in use (47%).

STUDY KEY FACTS

- CX practitioner study
- XM Institute network
- Conducted in Q1 of 2025
- 223 practitioners
- Orgs with 1,000+ employees

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The State of Customer Experience Management, 2025

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STUDY OVERVIEW

The data for this report comes from a CX practitioner study that Qualtrics XM Institute conducted in the first quarter of 2025. Using an online survey, XM Institute collected data from 223 CX practitioners from organizations with 1,000 or more employees.

XM Institute surveyed CX management practitioners connected through our subscriber list for our monthly newsletter and other professional networking sites.

FIGURES IN THE REPORT

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4. CX Competency Maturity
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23. Current AI Actions
24. Current AI Solutions

Methodology

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Priority of Improving XM Areas

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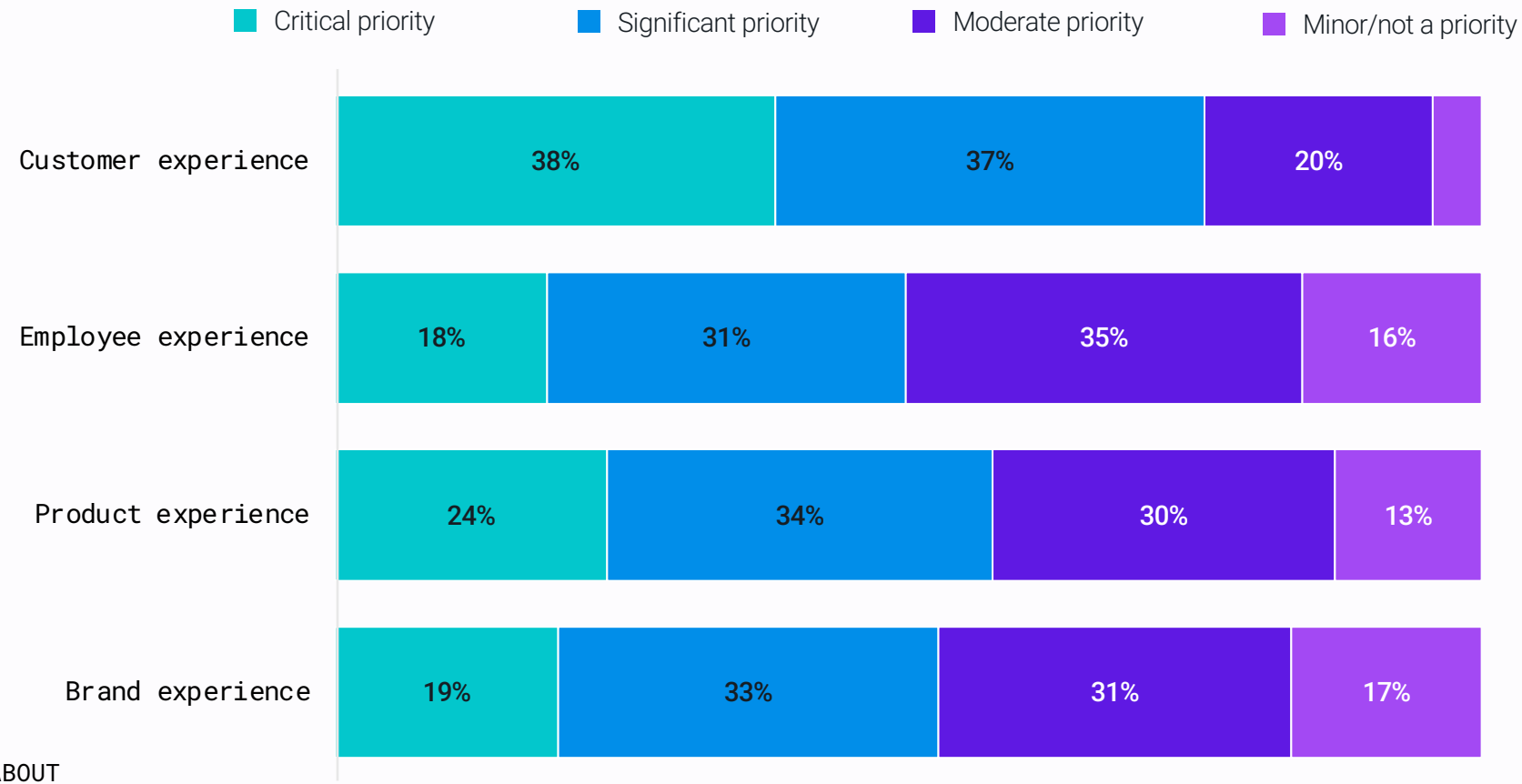
What priority does your organization put on improving the following:



ABOUT

Base: 223 CX practitioners at orgs with 1,000+ employees
Source: Qualtrics XM Institute Q1 2025 CX Practitioner Study

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CX Technology, Competency, and Culture

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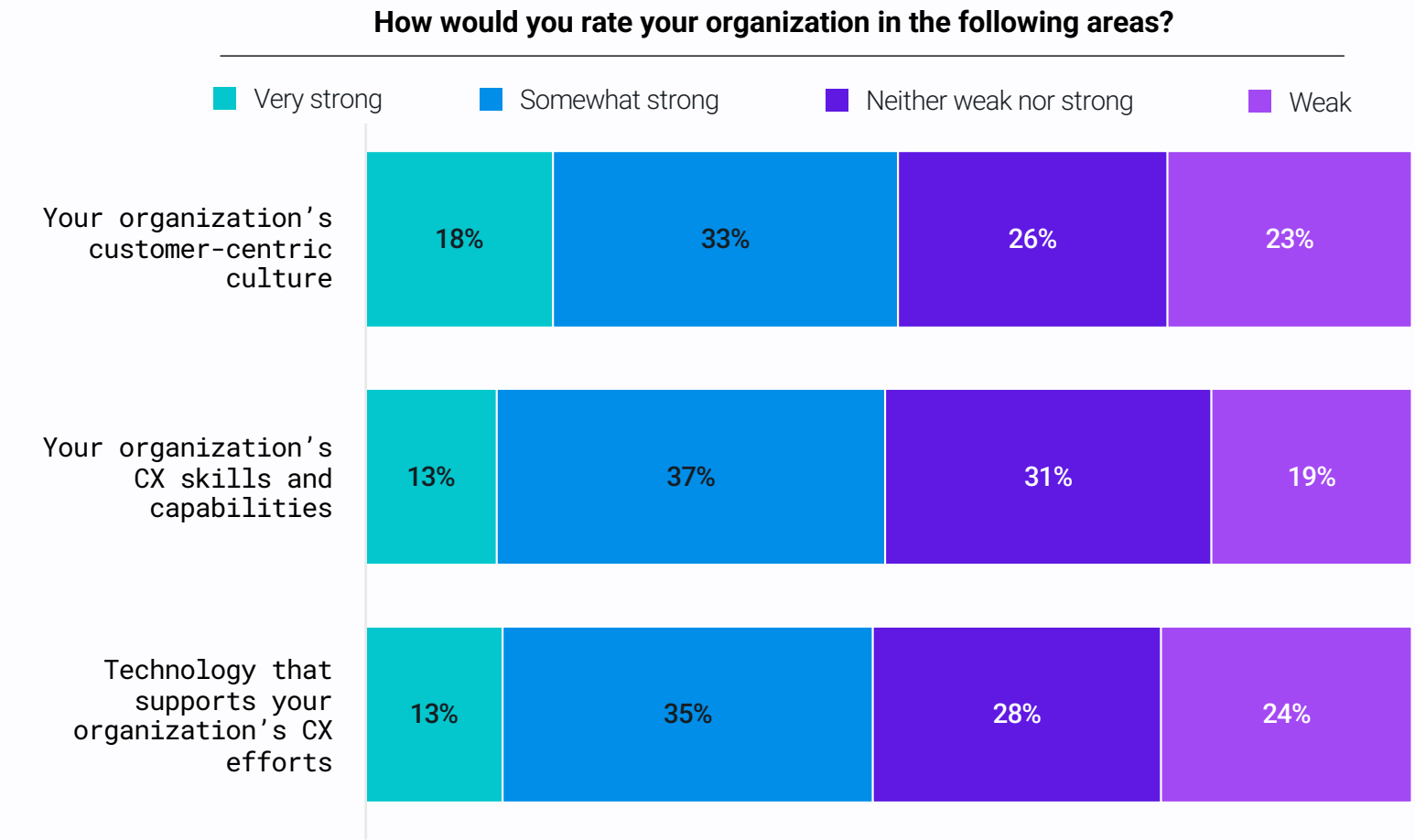

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CX Competency Assessment

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Steps to calculate the CX Competency Assessment

Step 1: Provide a numerical rating for all 20 CX skills based on this criteria

To what extent does your organization's CX program demonstrate the following behaviors ("**1**" to "**5**")?

1: Never
2: Infrequently
3: Sometimes
4: Almost Always
5: Always

Step 2: Calculate scores for each of the six competencies based on the average score of the related skills

Ratings of CX competencies (average scores)

Less than 2.60: Very Weak
2.60 - 3.29: Weak
3.30 - 3.89: Adequate
3.90 - 4.49: Strong
4.50 - 5.00: Very Strong

Step 3: Calculate the overall CX competency maturity score by adding together the scores from the individual competencies

Competency Maturity level (total score)

6 - 14: Level 1: Investigate
15 - 18: Level 2: Initiate
19 - 22: Level 3: Mobilize
23 - 26: Level 4: Scale
27 - 30: Level 5: Embed

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CX Competency Maturity

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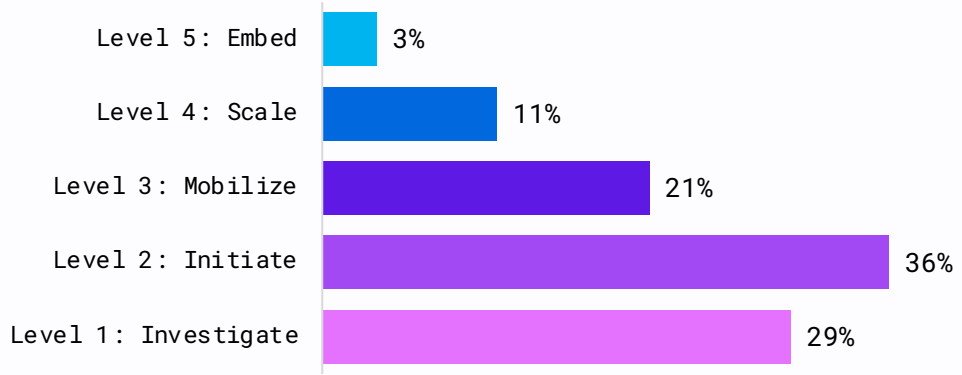
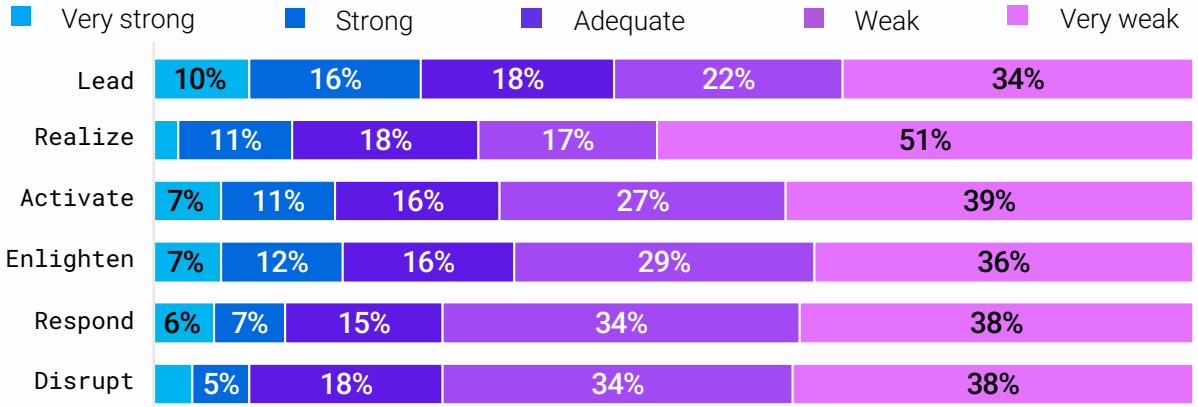
Stages of CX Competency Maturity



CX Competency Ratings



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CX Coordination

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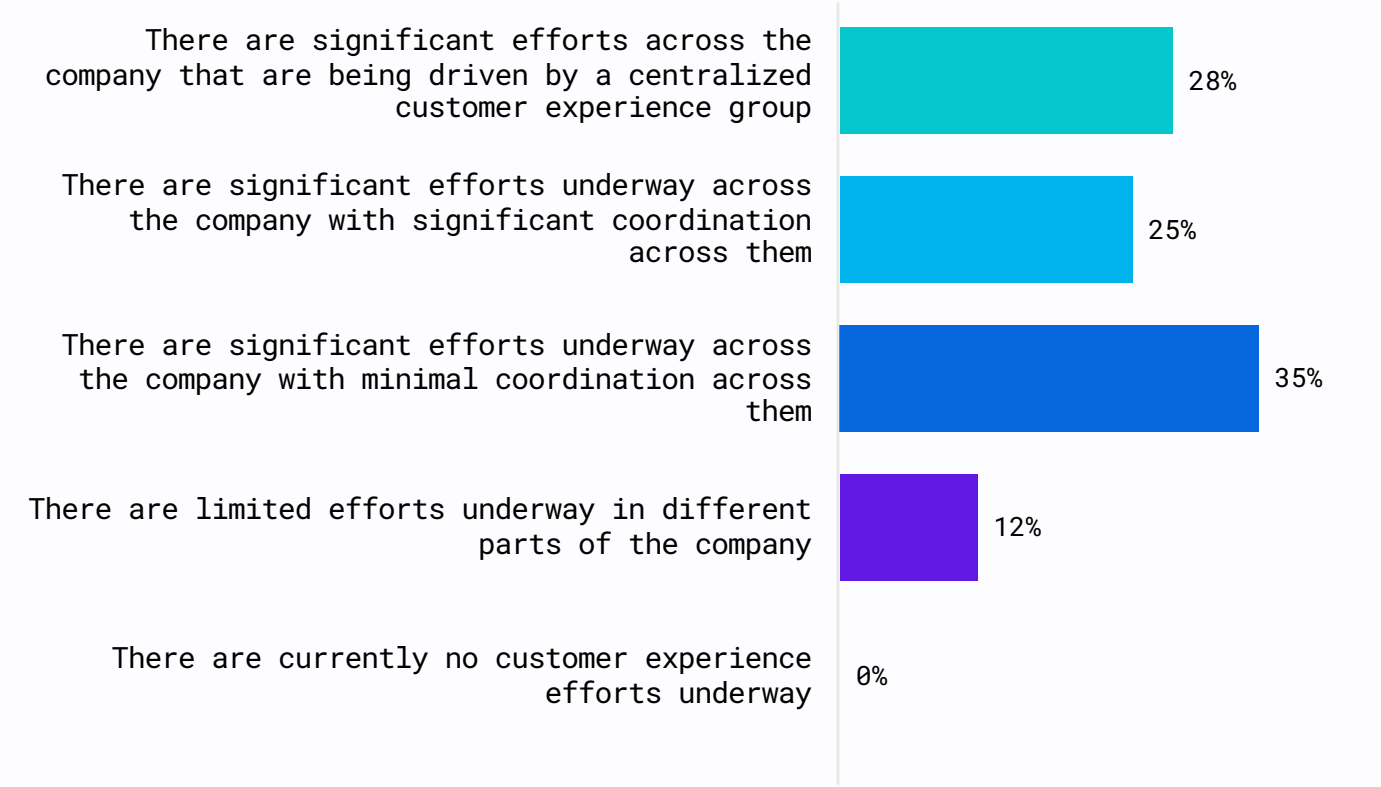
Which of the following best describes the customer experience efforts within your company?



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CX Governance Elements

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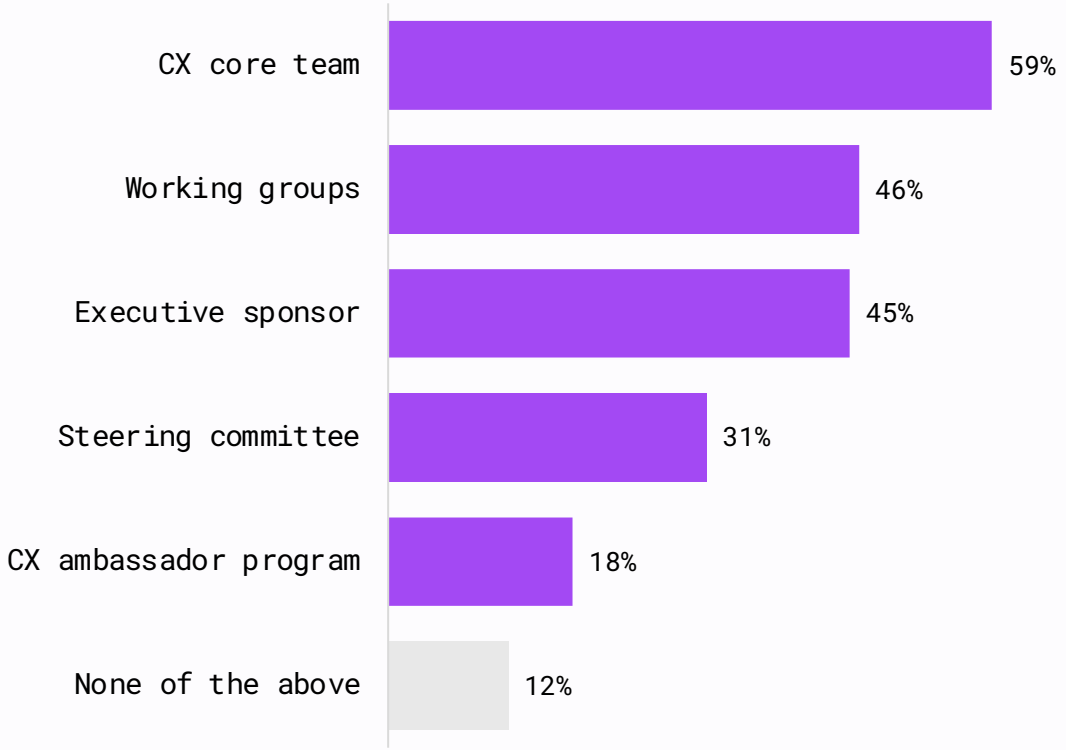
Which of the following governance elements are in place for your CX program?
(Select all that apply)



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CX Governance Elements: CX Leaders vs Laggards

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Which of the following governance elements are in place for your CX program?
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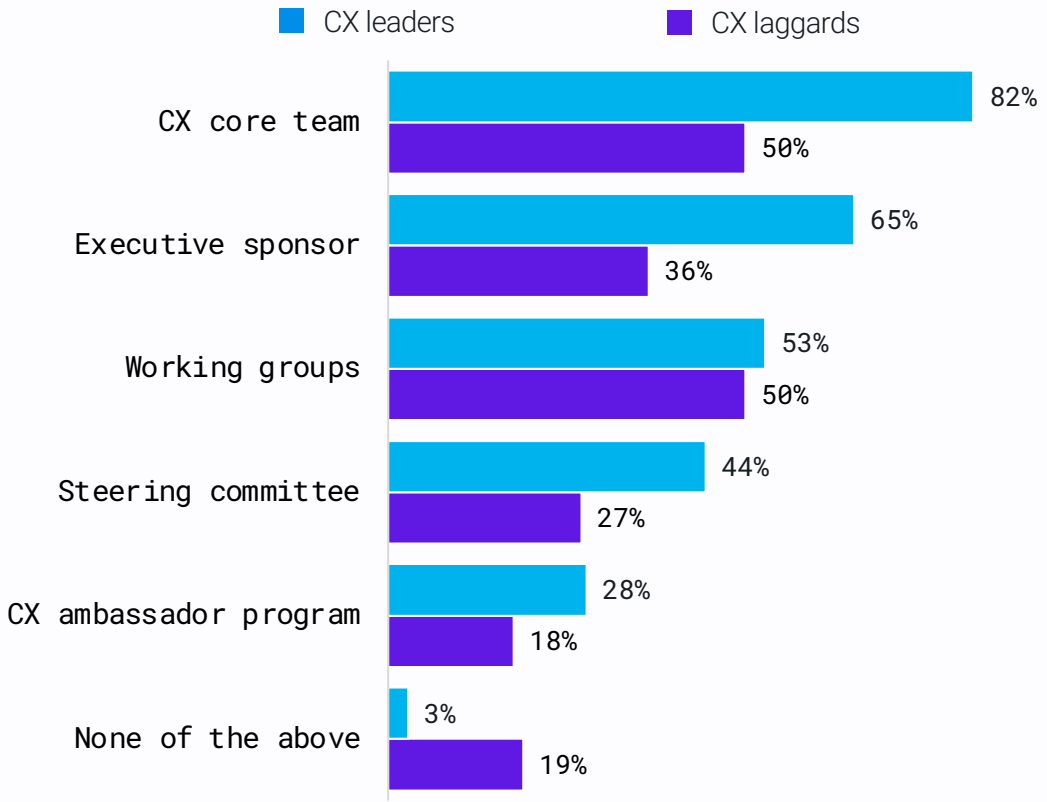

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Core CX Team: Size and Responsibilities

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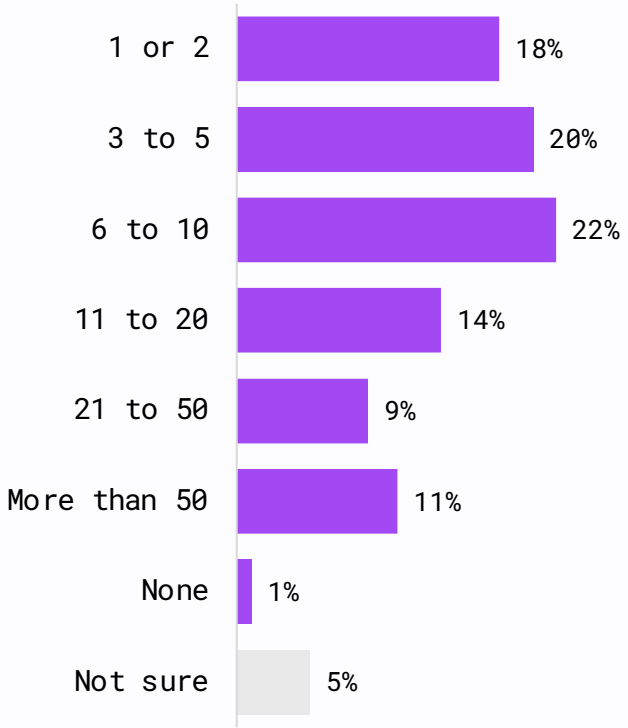
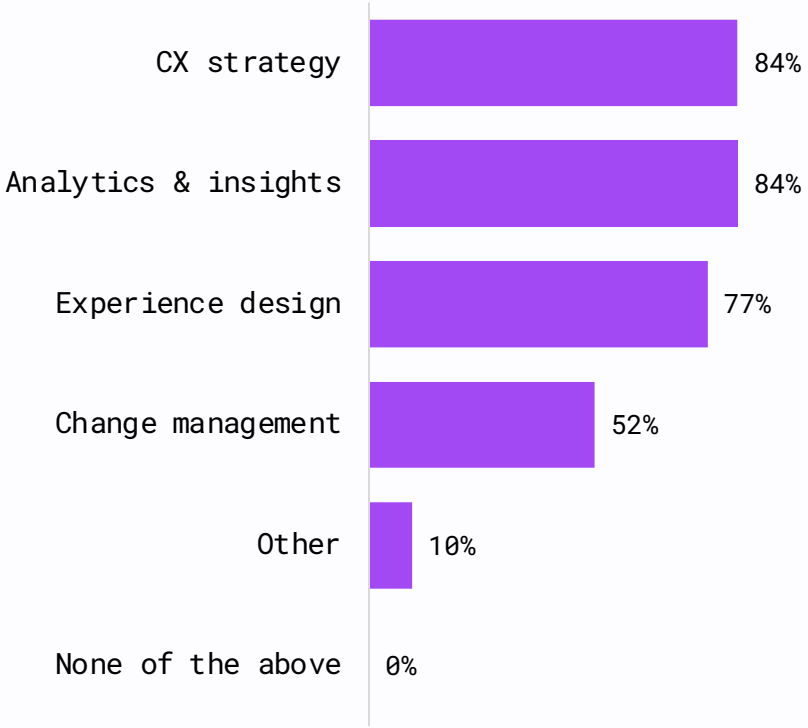
How many employees are dedicated full-time to your core CX team at your organization?



Which of the following are responsibilities of your core CX team?
(Select all that apply)



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CX Leadership

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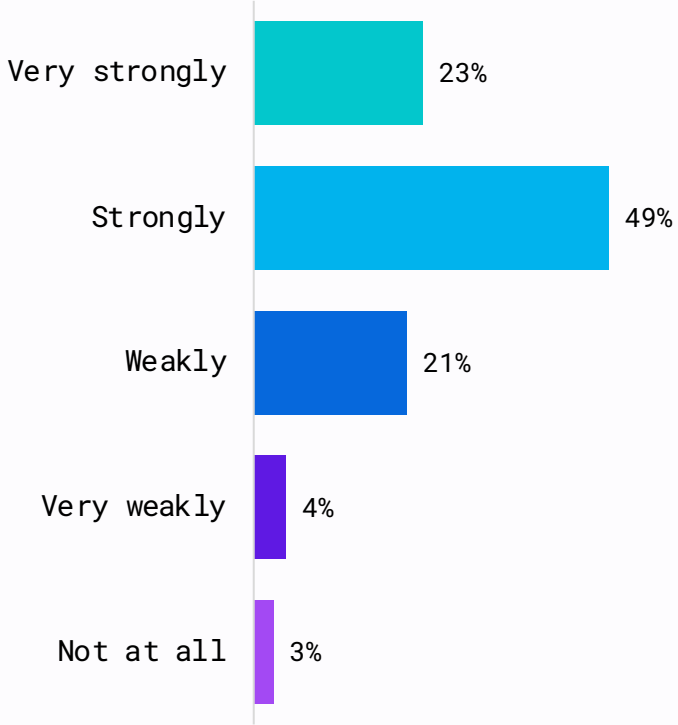
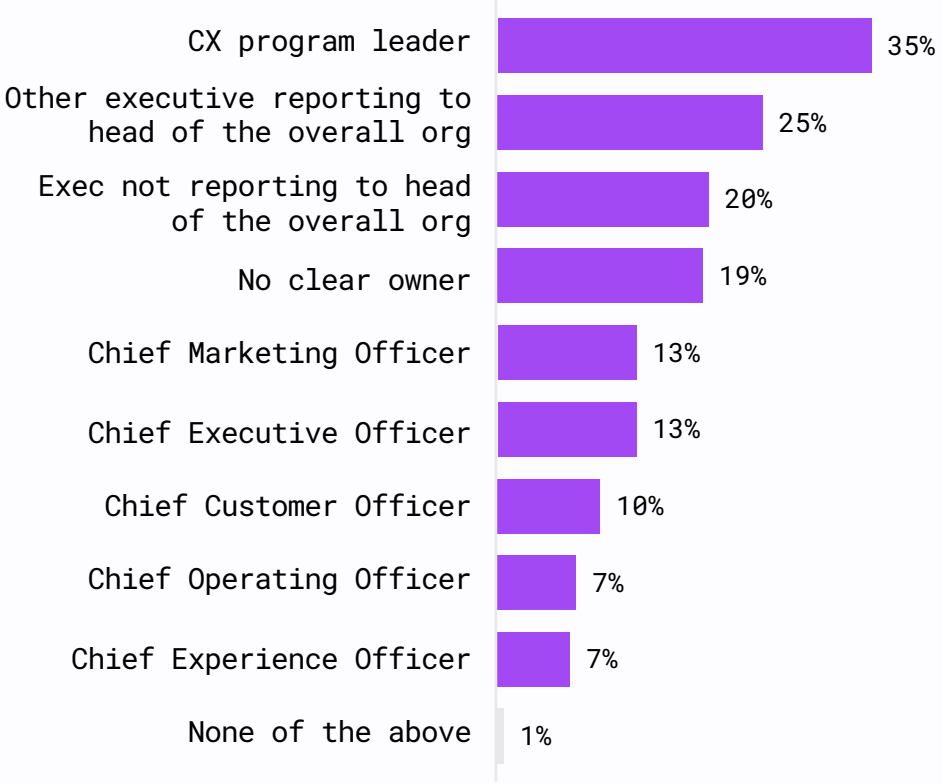
To what degree does your CEO (or the executive in charge of your organization) act as an active champion for customer experience?



Who is primarily responsible for driving the customer experience agenda in your organization?
(Select all that apply)



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CX Leadership: CX Leaders vs Laggards

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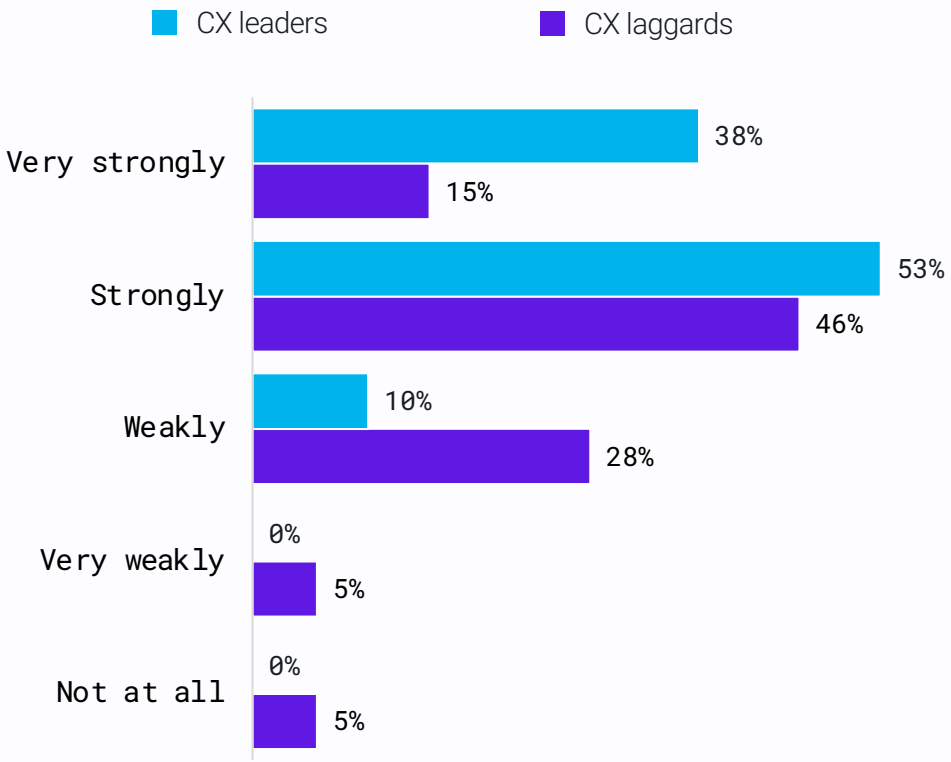
To what degree does your CEO (or the executive in charge of your organization) act as an active champion for customer experience?



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Spending on CX Resources

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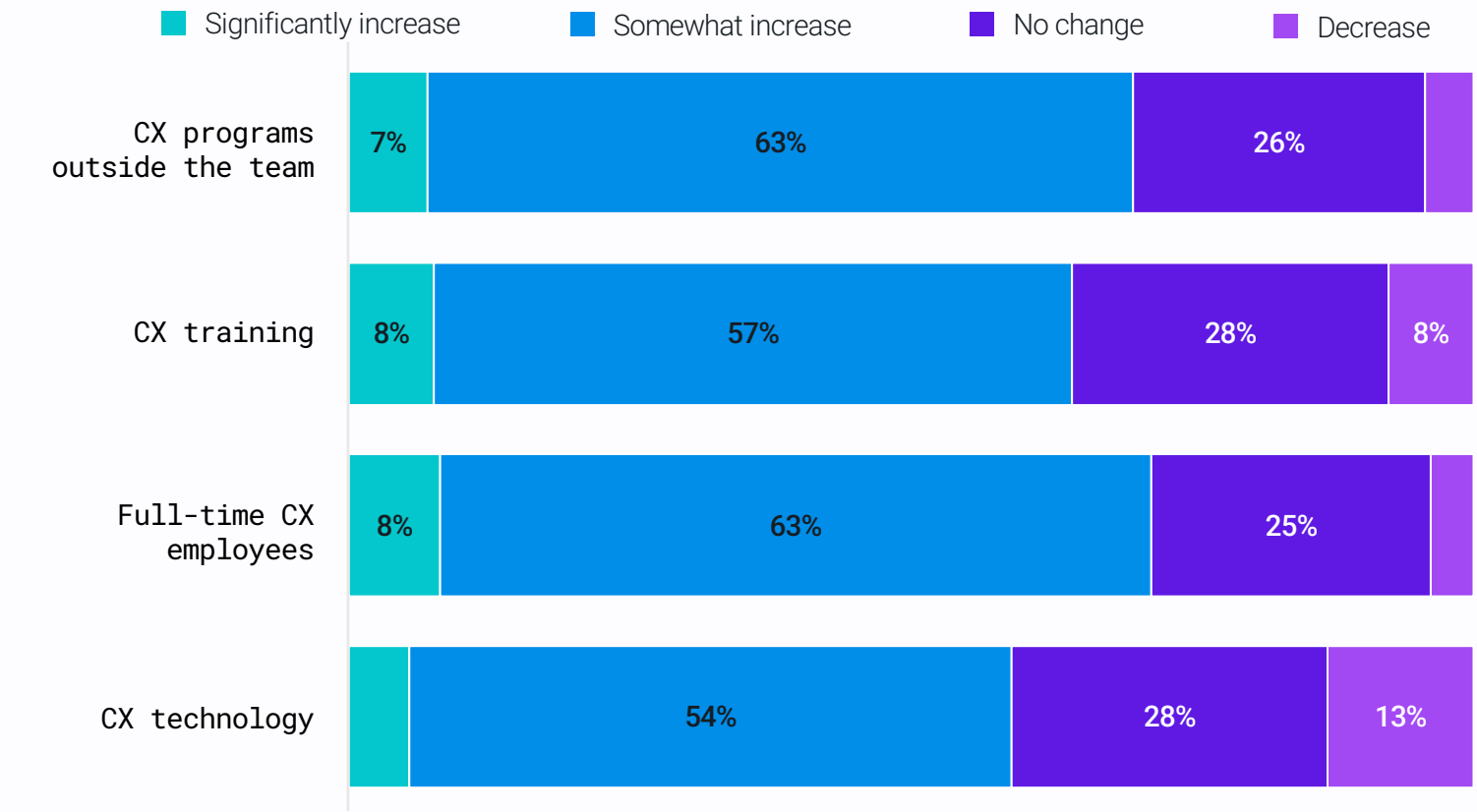
Compared to the past twelve months, how will the amount your organization spends on the following change over the next twelve months?



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Spending on CX Resources: CX Leaders vs Laggards

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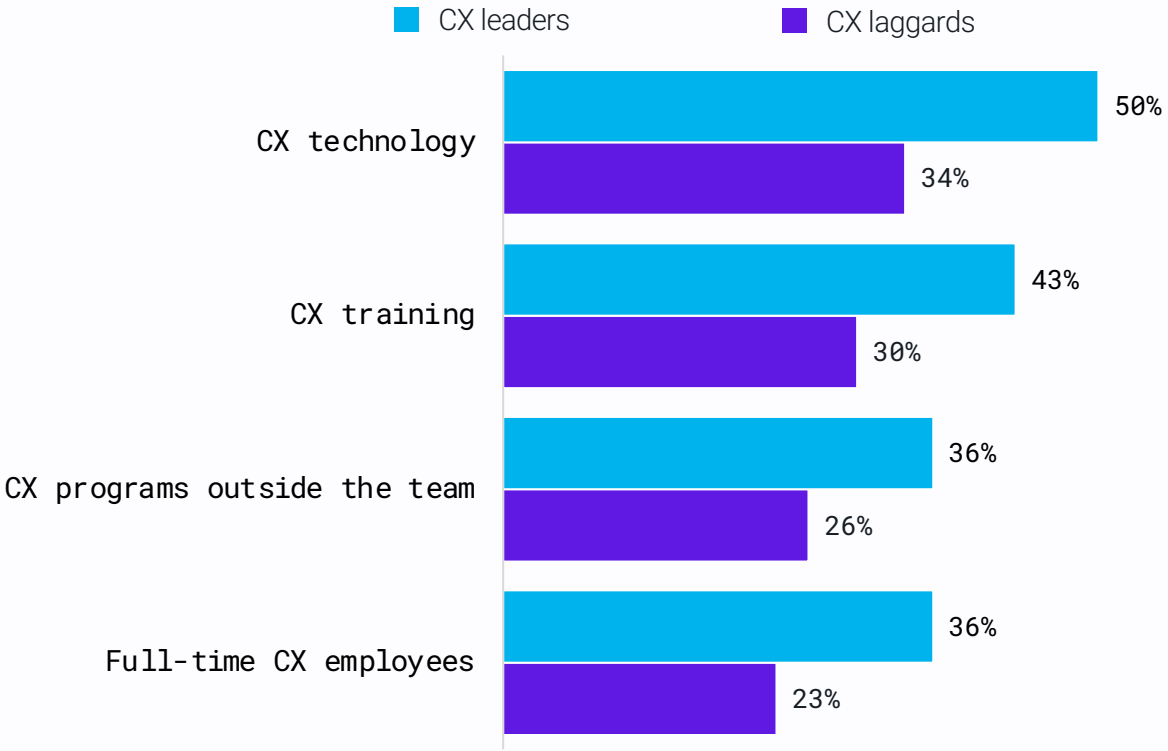
Compared to the past twelve months, how will the amount your organization spends on the following change over the next twelve months?

(Somewhat or significantly increased)



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Listening Elements

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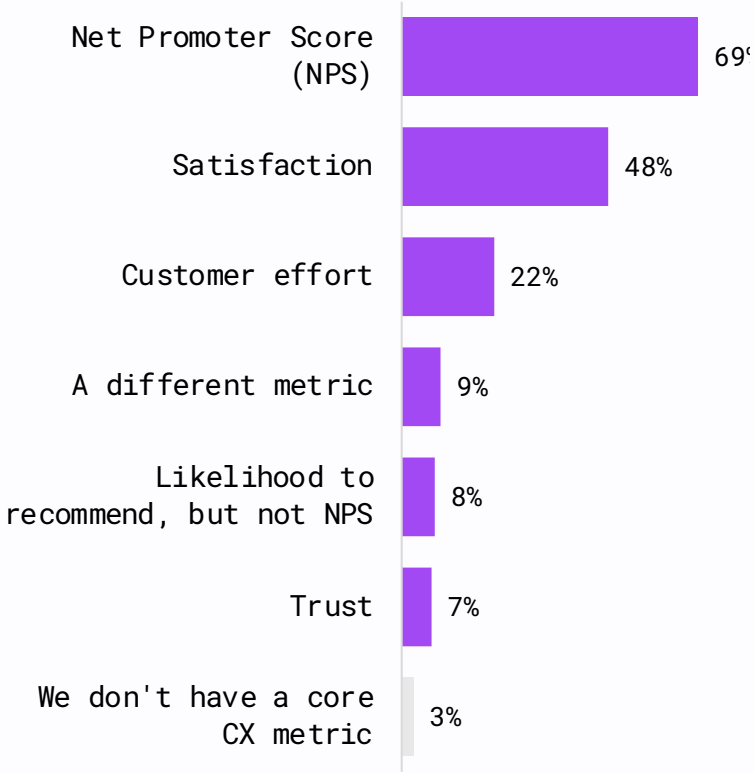
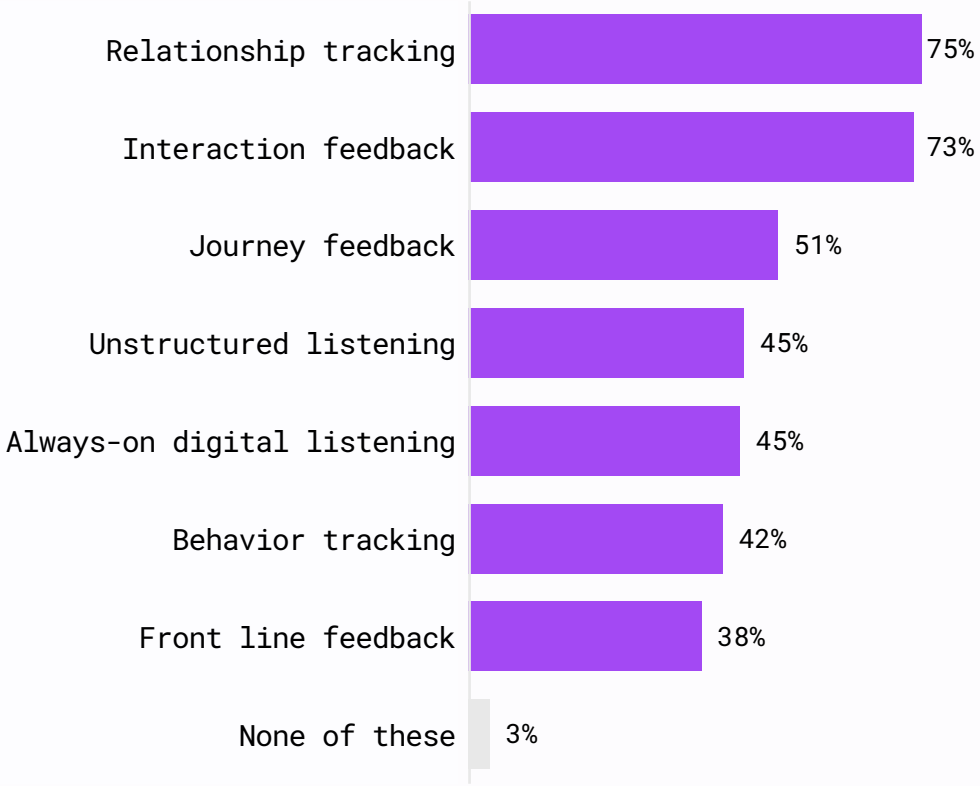
Which of the following is the core CX metric?
(Pick one or more if they are equally important)



Which of the following listening elements are part of your customer experience program?
(Select all that apply)



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Channel Experience

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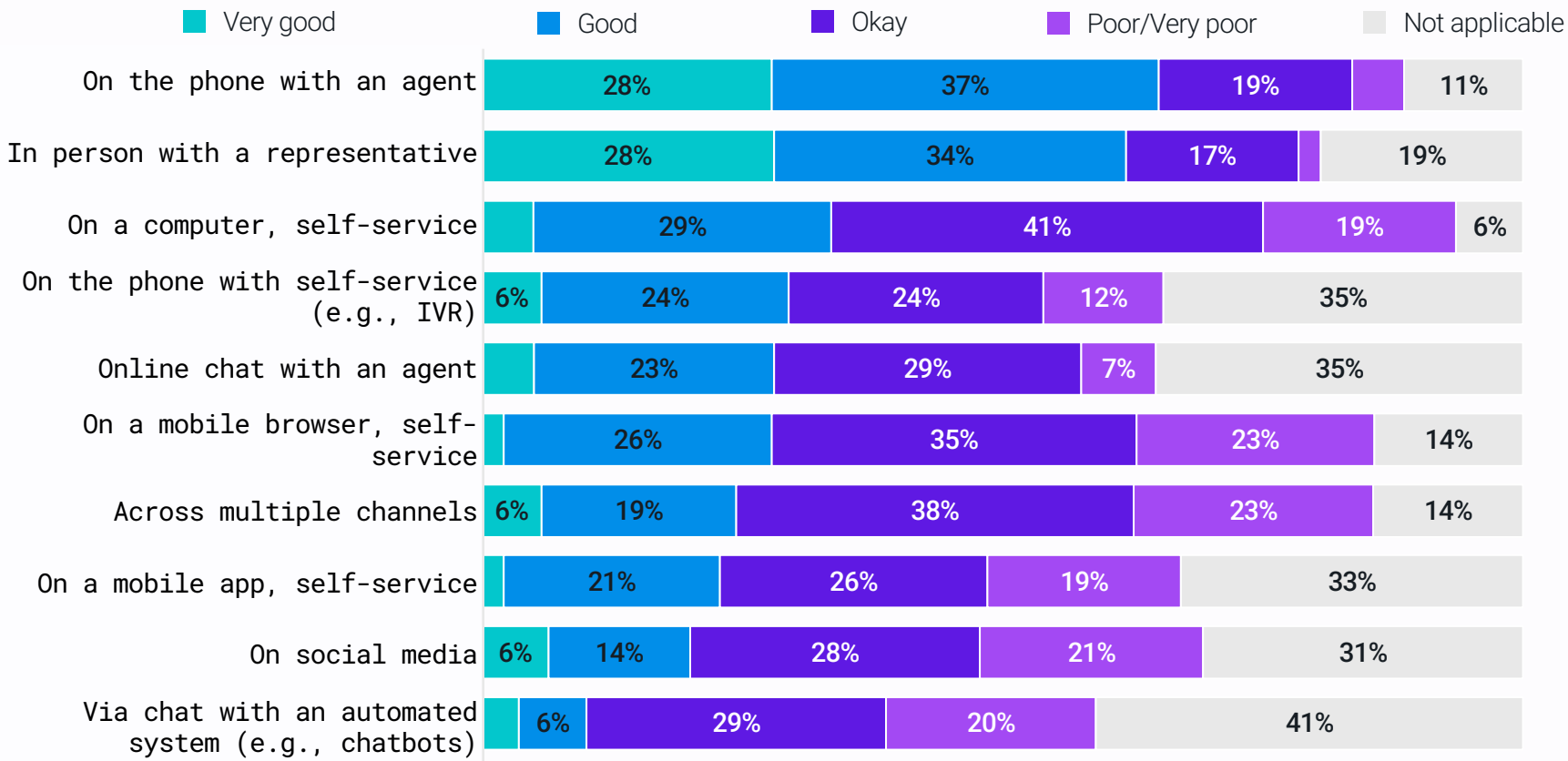
How would you rate the experience that your organization typically delivers through the following interaction channels?



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Broken Customer Journeys

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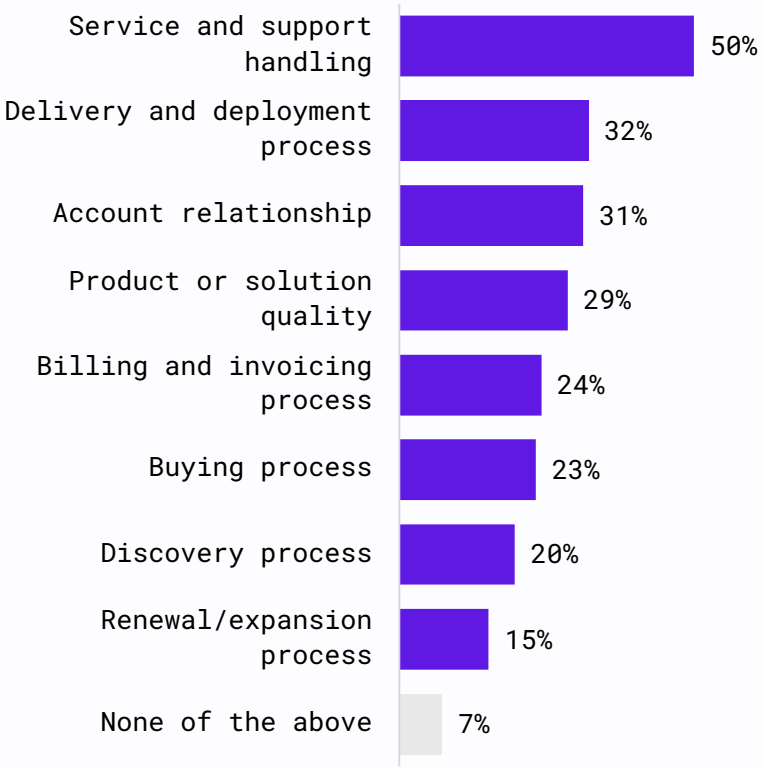
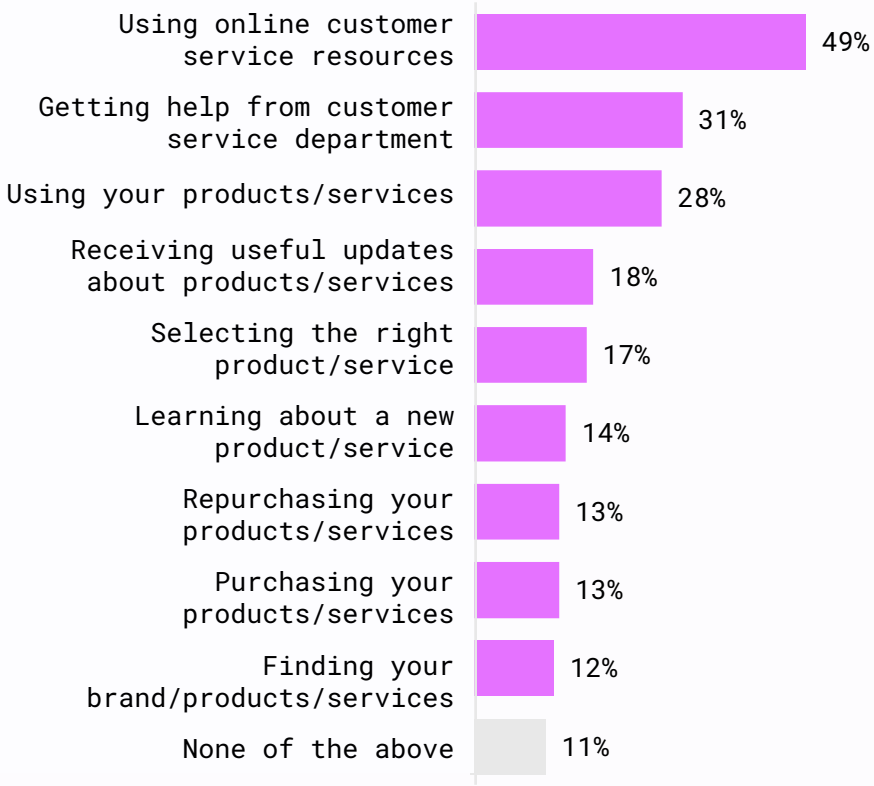
Business Customers Broken Journeys
(Select up to three)



Consumers Broken Journeys
(Select up to three)



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Obstacles to CX Success

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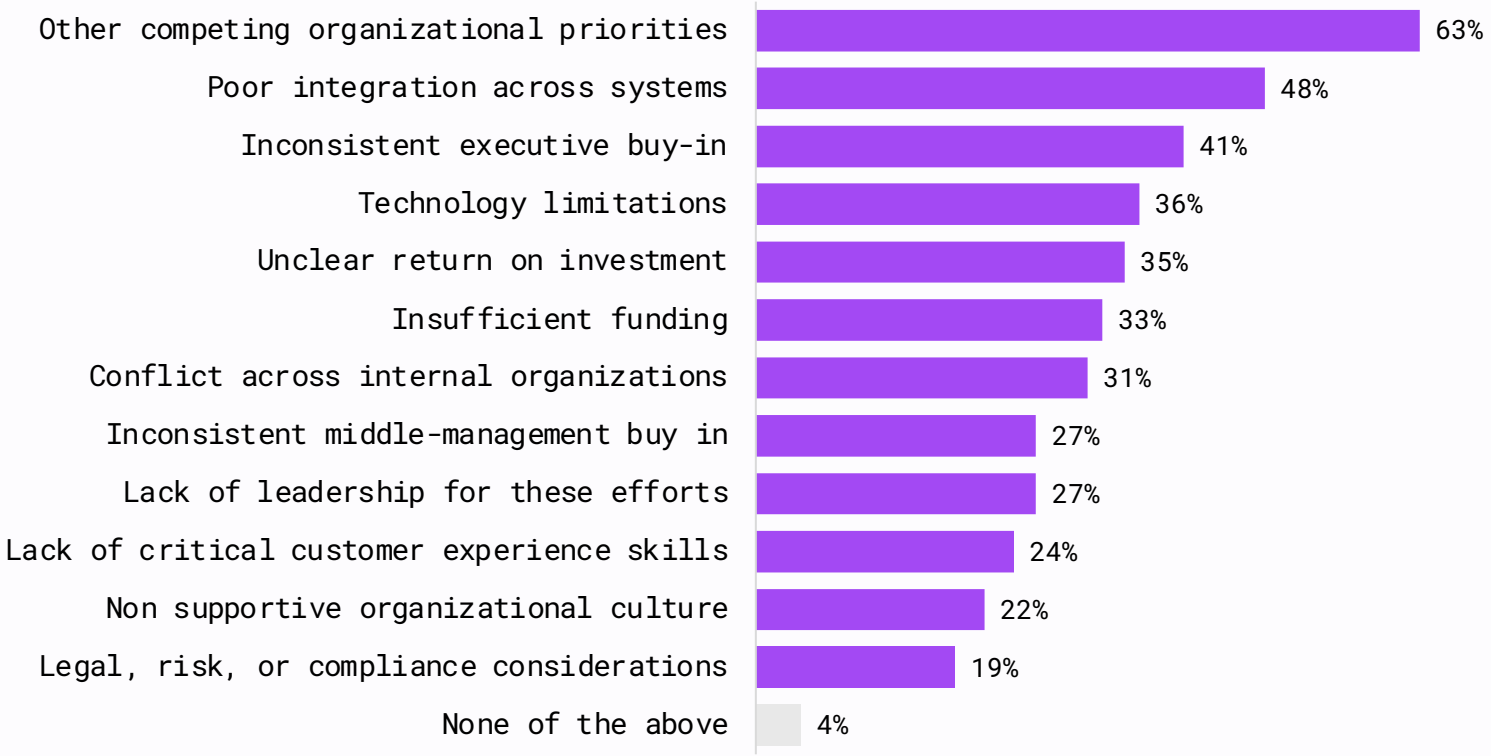
Which of the following do you consider to be significant obstacles to your organization's customer experience efforts?
(Select all that apply)



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Ambition Toward Modern XM

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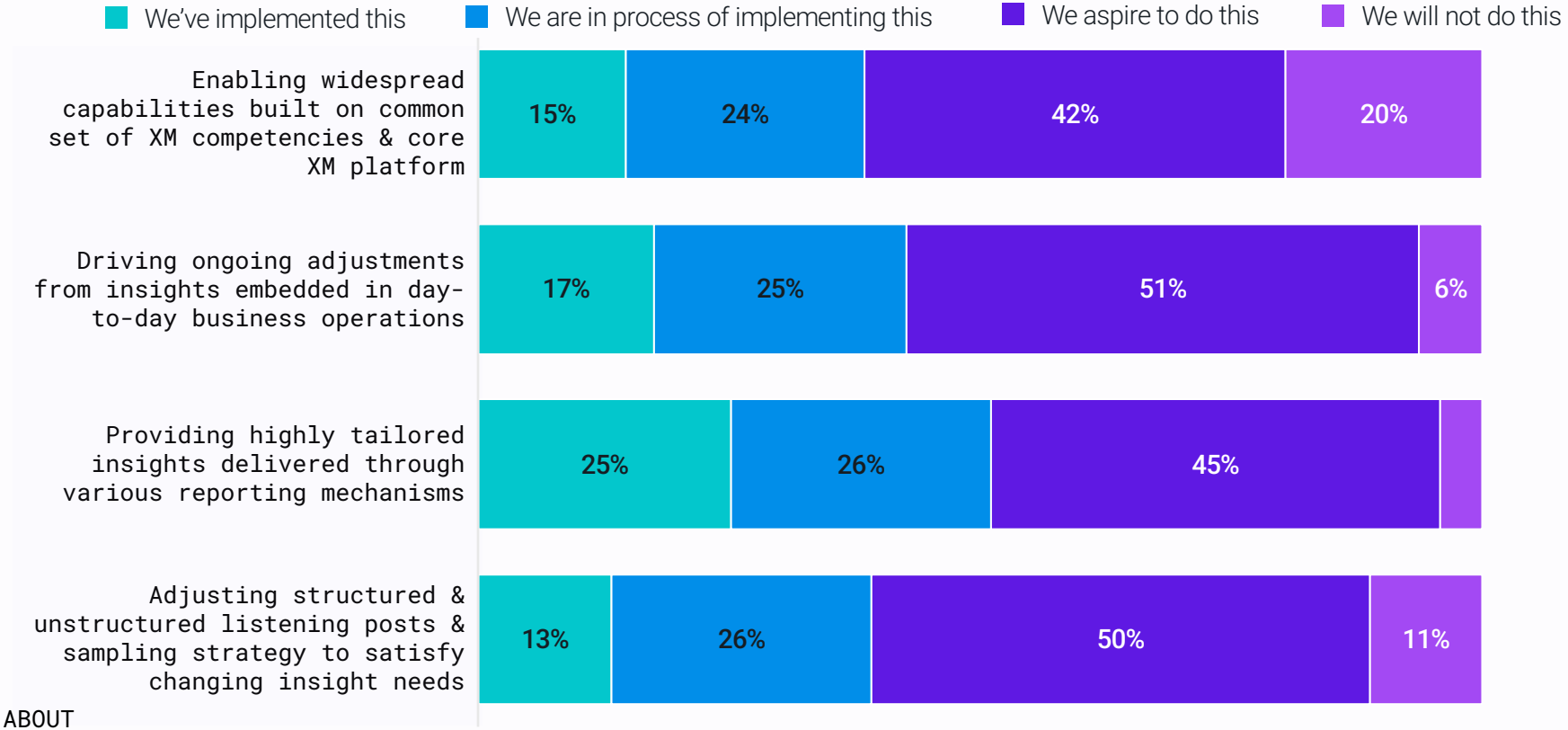
Which of the following best describes your level of ambition toward the following activities of customer experience over the next year?



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Connecting Employee and Customer Experience

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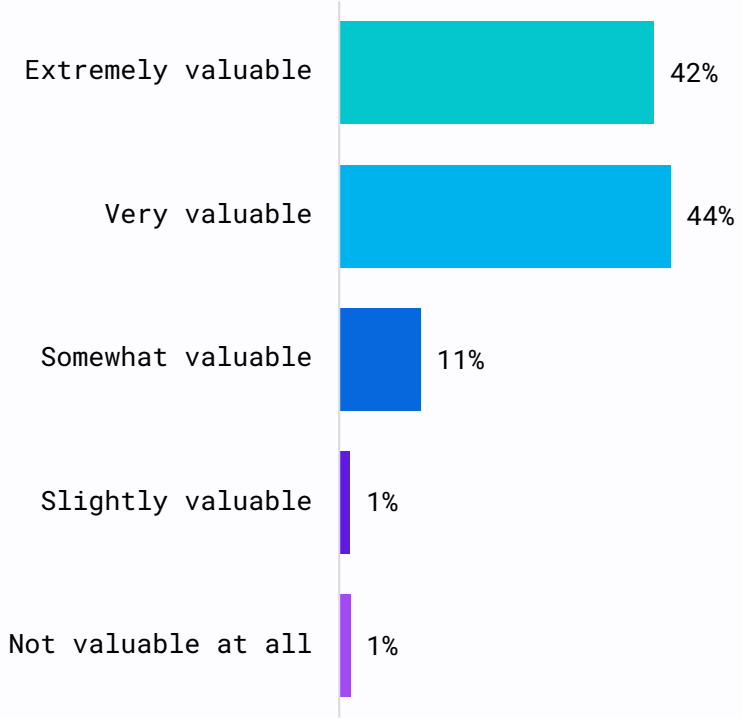
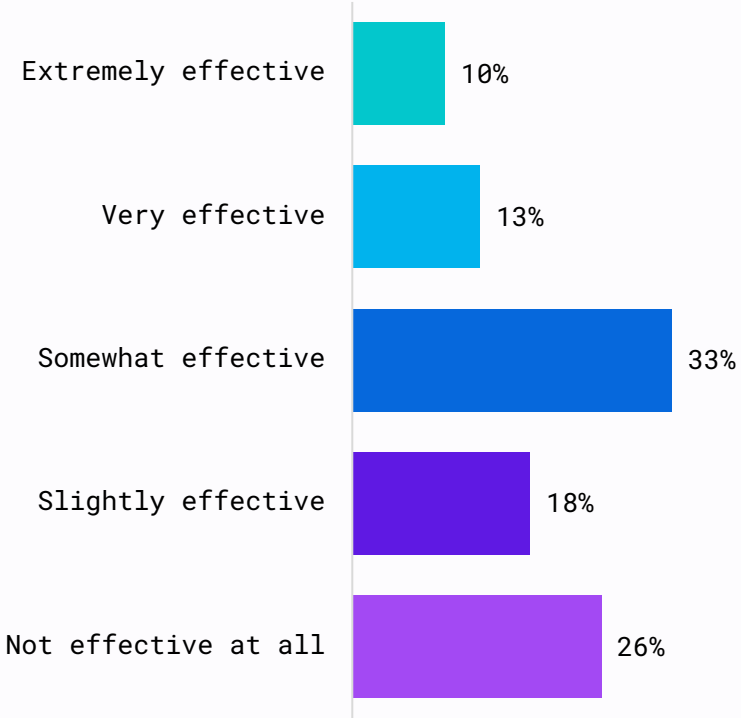
How valuable do you think it would be for your organization to identify the elements of employee experience that have the strongest impact on your organization's customer experience?



How effective is your organization at identifying the elements of employee experience that have the strongest impact on your organization's customer experience?



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Identifying Value of CX Programs

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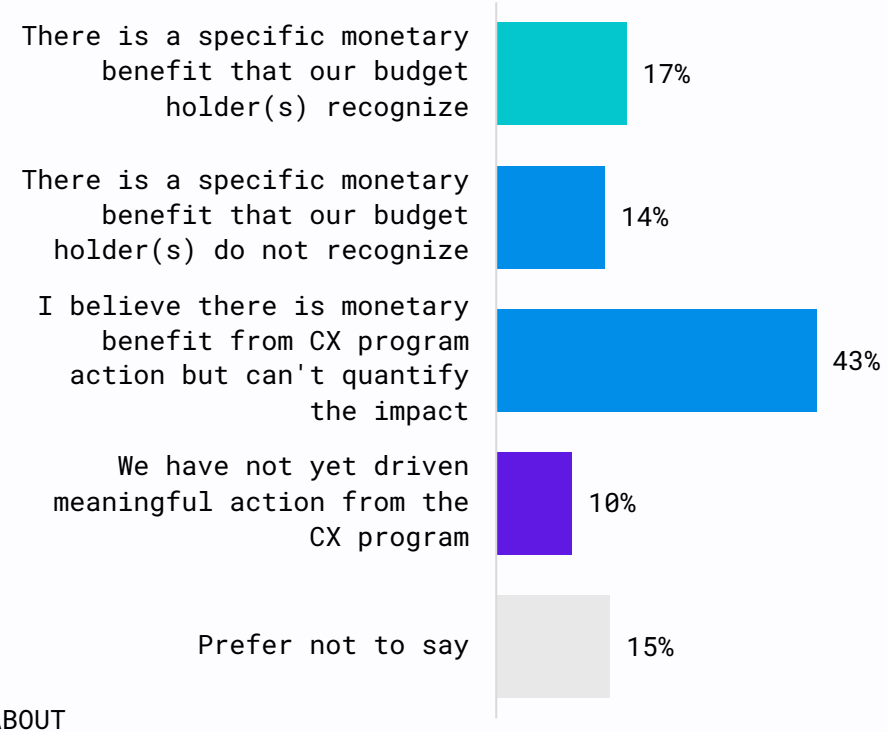
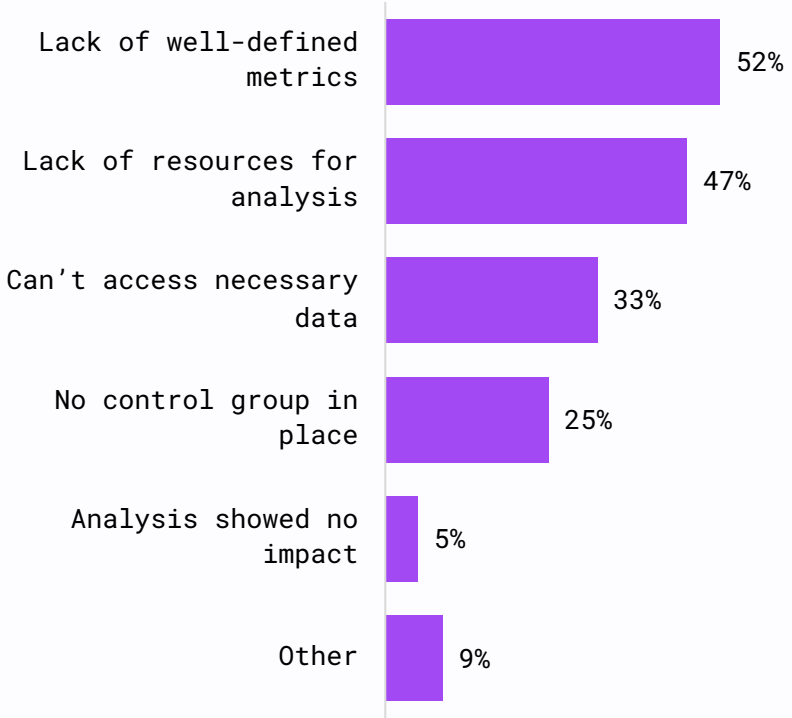
To what degree can you identify a specific monetary benefit that your customer experience program has contributed to in the previous year?



What has kept you from quantifying the impact of the actions you have driven?
(Of those that can't quantify impact/unrecognized benefits)



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CX Technology

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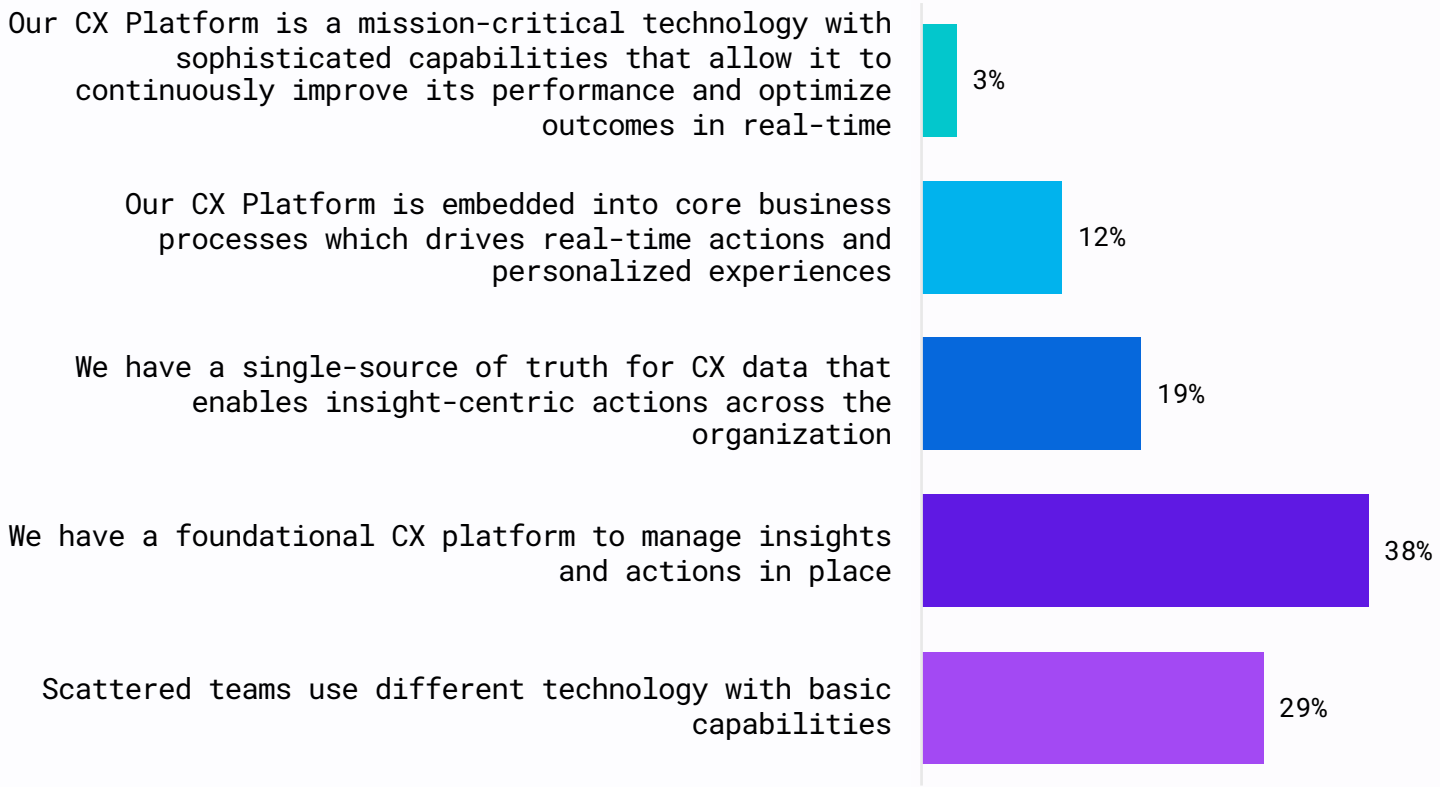
Which of the following best describes the state of CX technology in your organization?



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AI Can Help CX

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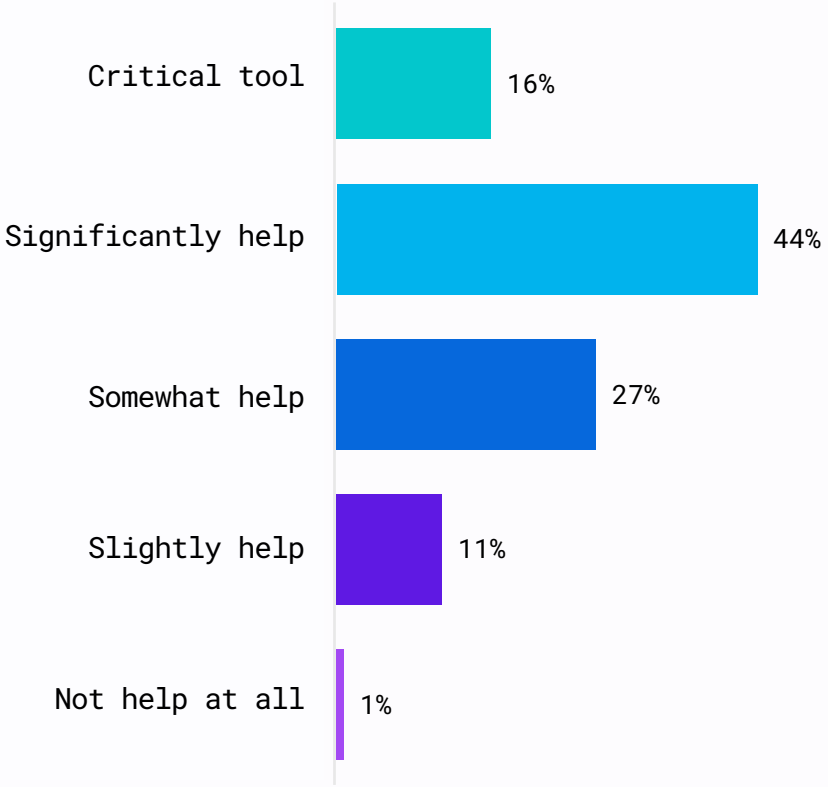
To what degree do you believe AI could help you achieve your customer experience goals?



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State of AI Implementation

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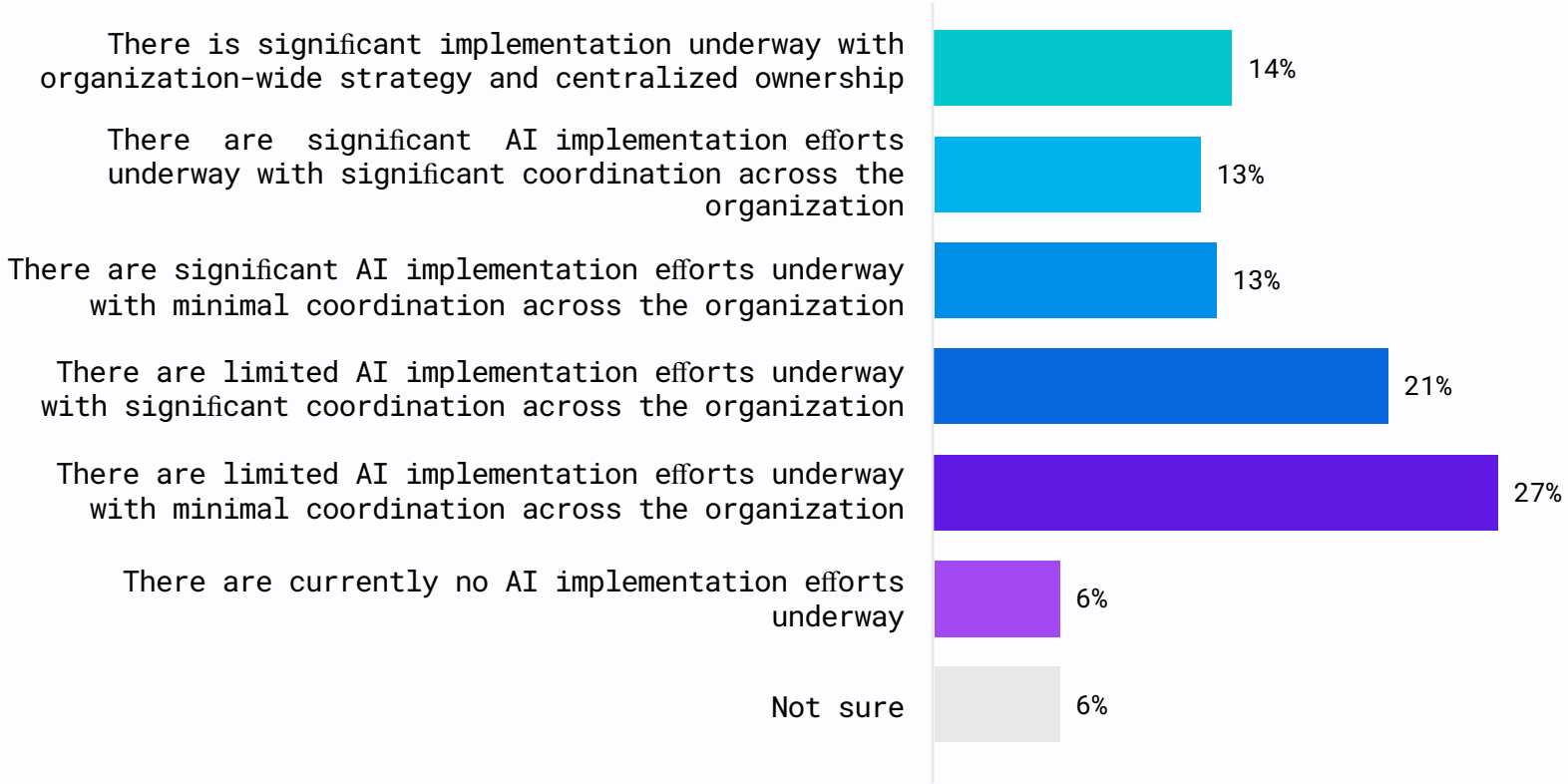
Which of the following best describes the state of AI implementation at your organization?



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Current AI Actions

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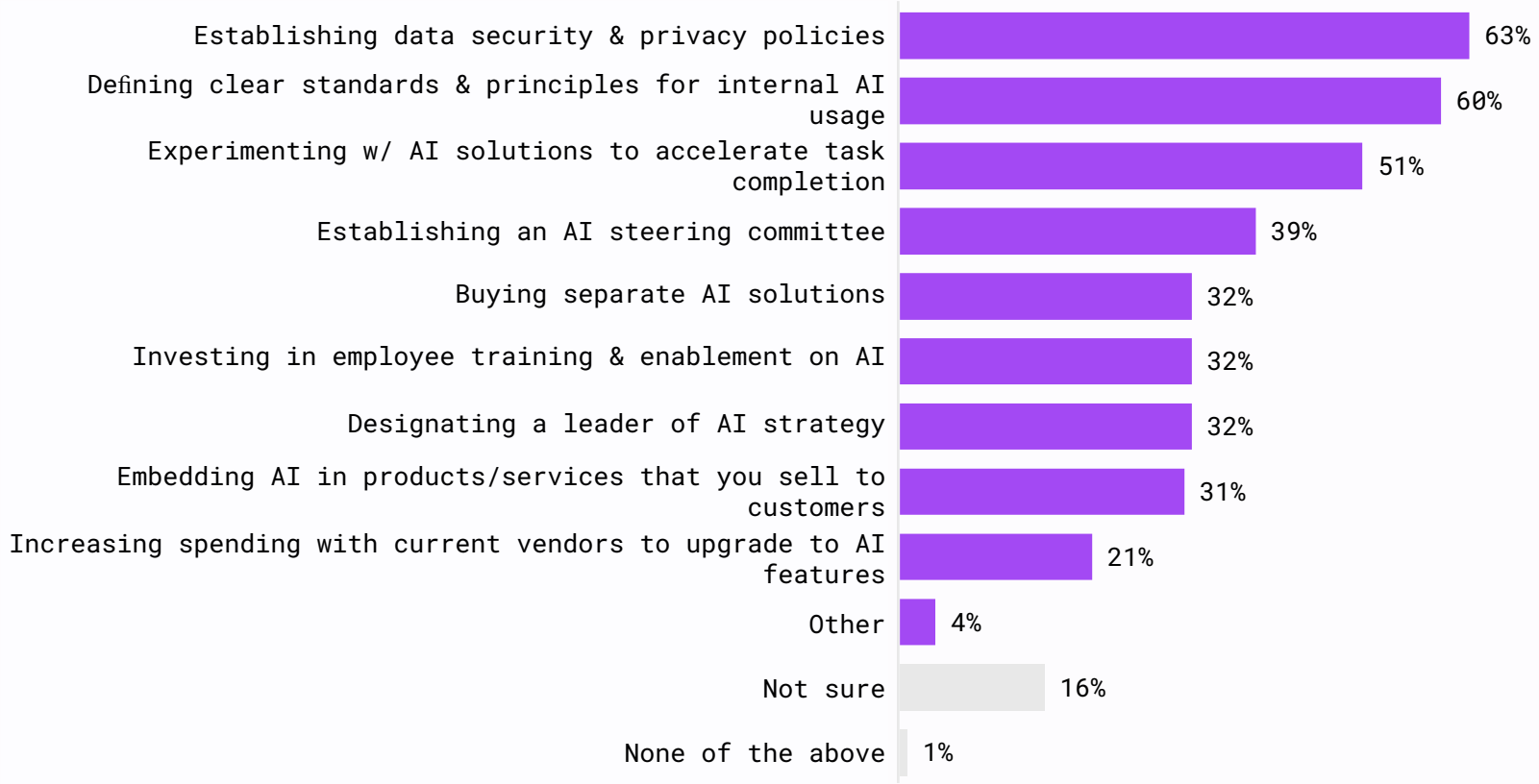
Which of the following currently describes the actions your organization is taking to implement AI?
(Select all that apply)



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Current AI Solutions

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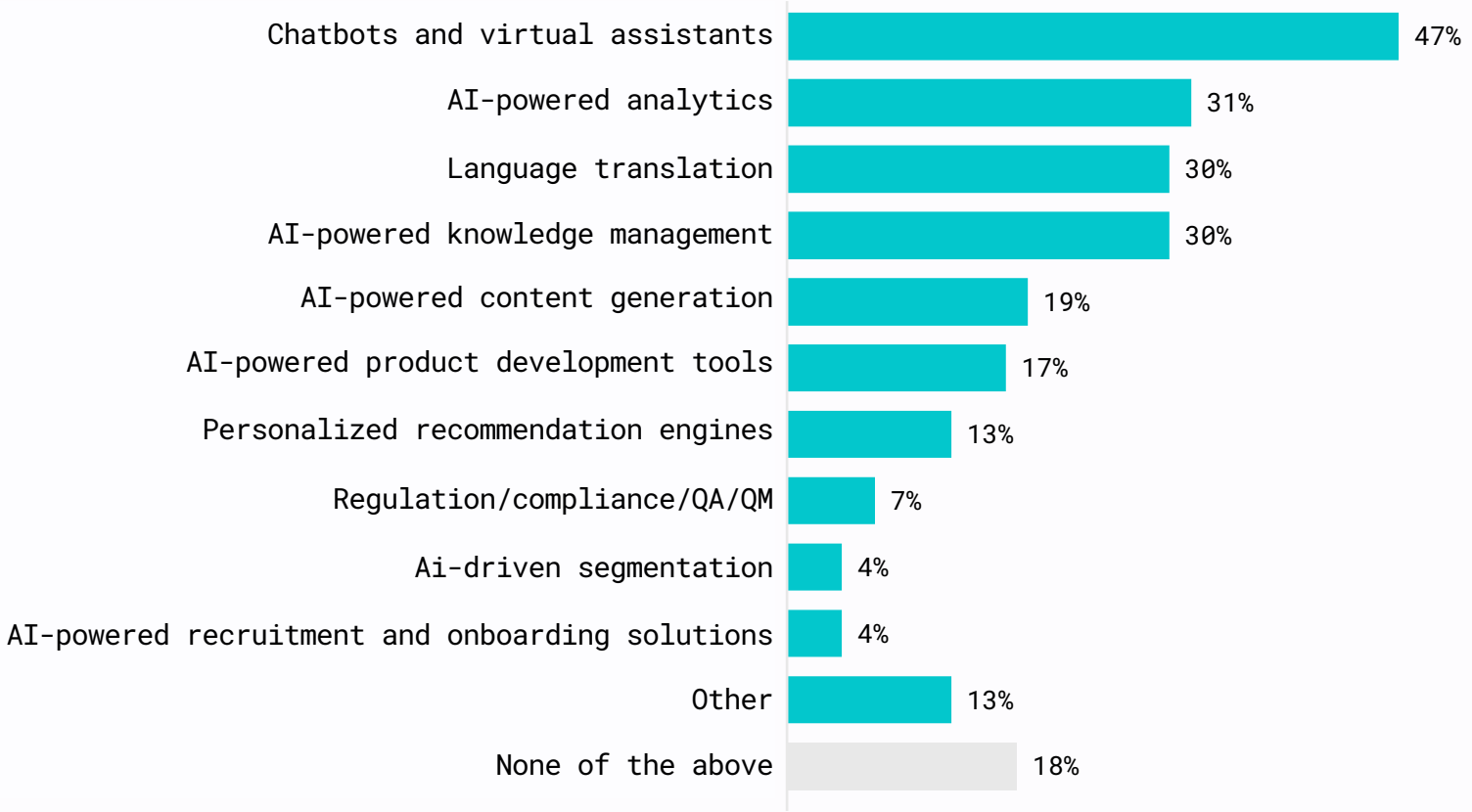
Which AI-powered solutions has your organization already implemented to improve customer experiences?
(Select all that apply)



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Methodology

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DATA CALCULATION

CX Leaders are identified as the respondents whose organizations achieved a maturity score above the median of 16.75. CX Laggards are those at or below the median.

Figures 23 and 24 are calculated as a percentage of the subset of organizations with some AI implementation efforts underway (NOT *currently no AI implementation efforts underway* or *not sure* – Figure 22).

Metrics below 6% are not labeled for clarity. Independent calculations may not match reporting due to rounding.

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